

SCROLLY DIAGNOSTIC SERIES

THE 25-POINT SHOPIFY SEO SELF-AUDIT

What to check before you spend another dollar on traffic.

25 checks | 30–45 minutes | Self-assessment

ScrollySEO

A companion diagnostic to the Shopify SEO Workbook

FRONT MATTER

Welcome

The 25-Point Shopify SEO Self-Audit

What to check before you spend another dollar on traffic.

Before you spend more on ads, it's worth checking something more basic: is your store actually structured, written, and connected in a way that search engines can understand, and that matches how customers search for what you sell? A store can have strong products and still be nearly invisible in organic search, not because anything is wrong with the products, but because of gaps in how the store communicates what it offers.

This audit walks you through 25 real checks across the parts of a Shopify store that most affect organic search: structure, product and collection pages, content, internal links, and technical basics. Each one asks you to actually look at your store, not recall it from memory, and several will point you toward something you can fix today.

Expect this to take 30–45 minutes. You'll come away knowing which parts of your store's SEO foundation are solid and which need attention, with a few real fixes already made along the way.

What You'll Need

- [ ] Your Shopify admin, logged in
- [ ] Your live storefront open (and on your phone, if possible)
- [ ] Google Search Console, if connected
- [ ] About 30–45 minutes, since several checks ask you to click through your store

How Scoring Works

Each of the 25 checks below is scored **1 point if genuinely true, 0 if not.** If you're honestly unsure whether something is true, that uncertainty is itself the answer: score it 0, and treat it as something worth confirming.

A note on what this score measures. This is a framework for finding where to focus, not a technical SEO grade and not a prediction of traffic or rankings. A store scoring 20 with a few specific, high-impact gaps may have more real opportunity to address than a store scoring 15 with only minor issues spread thin. Read your section-by-section pattern, not just the total.

1 Search Foundation

CHECKS 1–3 OF 25

WHY THIS MATTERS

Every other check in this audit assumes you're optimizing toward the right target. If that target is off, being technically excellent everywhere else won't fix it.

Score This	1 pt each
1.1. Can you list, with real confidence rather than a guess, the exact phrases your best customers actually type into Google before finding something like what you sell? If you're not sure, have you ever checked real data (Search Console, customer conversations, reviews) to confirm it?	☐
1.2. Pick your top 3 products or collections. For each, does the primary term you're targeting match how a real customer would search ("organic cotton baby blanket"), rather than internal language your team uses (a SKU name, an internal collection label)?	☐
1.3. For your highest-priority page, does the page type actually match the search intent behind it? A page built to sell one specific item won't serve someone who's still comparing options; that search may need an article or comparison page instead.	☐

Check the box only if it's genuinely true today

Section 1 total ___ / 3

2 Store Structure

CHECKS 4–7 OF 25

WHY THIS MATTERS

Structure determines whether a search engine, and a customer, can find the right page in a reasonable number of steps, and whether your catalog is organized around how people actually shop rather than how your inventory happens to be arranged.

Score This	1 pt each
2.1. Open your site navigation as a first-time visitor would. Is it organized around how a customer thinks about your catalog (by need, use case, or a category they'd actually search for), rather than your internal inventory logic?	☐
2.2. Do you have collections built around real, distinct customer intent ("Gifts Under $50," "Non-Toxic Candles"), rather than one broad, undifferentiated collection holding everything?	☐
2.3. Pick 3 of your collections. Does each one have a clear reason to exist as its own page (enough distinct products, a genuinely different intent from your other collections), rather than being close enough to another collection that the two could realistically be merged?	☐
2.4. Is every important page, a flagship product, a key collection, linked from your navigation or from another page a customer would naturally find, rather than only reachable through a direct URL or a search?	☐

Check the box only if it's genuinely true today

Section 2 total ____ / 4

3 Product SEO

CHECKS 8–11 OF 25

WHY THIS MATTERS

Product pages are usually where the money is, and usually where the SEO is thinnest, since they're often the pages a store owner touches least after initial setup.

Score This	1 pt each
3.1. Open your 5 best-selling products. Does each have a unique title and meta description (the headline and snippet shown in a Google result) that reflects how a customer would search, rather than several products sharing near-identical, templated versions?	☐
3.2. Read one product description as if you'd never heard of your brand. Does it answer real buying questions (materials, sizing, use case, what makes it different), rather than reading as manufacturer or supplier boilerplate?	☐
3.3. Check the alt text on your product images (right-click → Inspect, or check the field in your Shopify admin). Does it actually describe what's in the image, rather than being left blank or filled with a generic filename like IMG_4821?	☐
3.4. For a product with real buying questions attached to it (sizing, compatibility, care instructions), is that information actually on the page, rather than requiring a customer to guess, email you, or leave to find it?	☐

Check the box only if it's genuinely true today

QUICK FIX

Rewrite the meta description on your single best-selling product right now, in one real sentence, using the words a customer would actually search.

Section 3 total ____ / 4

4 Collection SEO

CHECKS 12–14 OF 25

WHY THIS MATTERS

A collection page is often the page that actually ranks for a broader category search, but it's frequently left as a bare product grid with nothing telling a search engine, or a visitor, what the collection is specifically about.

Score This	1 pt each
4.1. Open your top 3 collection pages. Does each have real, unique introductory copy explaining what the collection is and who it's for, rather than jumping straight into products with zero context?	☐
4.2. Does each of your collections serve a genuinely different search or customer need, rather than mostly duplicating another collection under a slightly different name or filter?	☐
4.3. Do your collection page titles and meta descriptions read like they were written for a specific search result ("Non-Toxic Soy Candles for Sensitive Homes"), rather than generic defaults like "Shop All" or "Collection"?	☐

Check the box only if it's genuinely true today

QUICK FIX

Add 2–3 sentences of real, specific copy to the top of your highest-priority collection page today.

Section 4 total ___ / 3

5 Content

CHECKS 15–17 OF 25

WHY THIS MATTERS

Not every search a potential customer runs is ready to buy. Content that answers earlier-stage questions captures that demand instead of losing it entirely to whichever competitor happens to answer it first.

Score This	1 pt each
5.1. Do you have any published content, blog posts, guides, FAQs, that answers the questions customers ask before they're ready to buy, rather than every page assuming the visitor has already decided to purchase?	☐
5.2. If you have content pages, do they connect back to relevant product or collection pages through real links in the body text, rather than existing in isolation with no path back to something you sell?	☐
5.3. Looking honestly at what you've published: does it cover a real, coherent set of topics connected to what you sell, rather than being a handful of disconnected posts with no clear plan behind them?	☐

Check the box only if it's genuinely true today

Section 5 total ___ / 3

6 Internal Linking

CHECKS 18–19 OF 25

WHY THIS MATTERS

Internal links are how both customers and search engines discover that your important pages are related to each other. Without them, every page is an island, regardless of how good each one is individually.

Score This	1 pt each
6.1. Do your most important pages, top products, top collections, link to each other in ways that make sense to a customer (related products, complementary collections), rather than existing without connections to each other?	☐
6.2. If you have content pages, do they link to the specific product or collection page they're most relevant to, using descriptive link text rather than generic "click here" or "shop now"?	☐

Check the box only if it's genuinely true today

Section 6 total ___ / 2

7 Google Visibility & Technical Basics

CHECKS 20–25 OF 25

WHY THIS MATTERS

None of the above matters if Google can't find, load, or properly display your pages in the first place. These checks are about visibility infrastructure, not content quality.

Score This	1 pt each

7.1. Have you ever connected Google Search Console to your store, and have you looked at it in the last 30 days? ☐

7.2. Using Search Console's URL Inspection tool, can you confirm your key pages are actually indexed? A quick `site:yourdomain.com` search can give a rough sense of what's indexed, but it's an unreliable, incomplete check on its own, not a substitute for inspecting specific URLs in Search Console. ☐

7.3. If you sell physical products, have you set up free Google product listings through Merchant Center so your products can appear in Google Shopping results at no cost? ☐

7.4. Load your site on your phone using mobile data, not wifi. Does it load in a few seconds and feel intentional, rather than noticeably lagging or feeling broken? ☐

7.5. Click through 10–15 links across your site (navigation, footer, a few product and collection links). Did your spot check turn up no broken links or unexpected redirects? ☐

7.6. Read your homepage and top product pages as if you were an AI assistant with no other context. Do they clearly and consistently state, in actual text rather than only images, what you sell, who it's for, and the key attributes or specifications a shopper would need? ☐

This last check tells you whether the underlying information is present and clear. It doesn't confirm whether an AI assistant would actually surface or recommend your store, which depends on additional factors this self-assessment can't test.

Check the box only if it's genuinely true today

QUICK FIX

If you found a broken link in your spot check, fix that one link now. It's a five-minute task with a real, if small, benefit.

Section 7 total ___ / 6

YOUR RESULTS

What Your Audit Shows

ADD UP YOUR SEVEN SECTION TOTALS

_____ / 25 Plot your total on the bands below

0–8	**Several Clear Foundation Gaps.** Several of the checks above point to specific, fixable gaps in how your store communicates with search engines. These are worth addressing before drawing conclusions about how well organic search could work for your store.
9–17	**Foundation Exists, Real Gaps Remain.** Parts of your store's SEO foundation are solid; other checks point to specific things worth fixing.
18–25	**Strong Foundation.** You're past the basics on most of what this audit checks. Remaining gains are more likely about depth and consistency than about fixing obvious gaps.

Plot Your Seven Section Scores

Read your section totals, not just the sum. A store that scores well across Sections 1–6 but weak on Section 7 has a visibility problem, not a content problem, and the fix looks different than a store with the opposite pattern. This audit describes patterns in what you found; it doesn't measure actual traffic, rankings, or revenue, which require real search and analytics data to determine.

1 · Search Foundation	/ 3
2 · Store Structure	/ 4
3 · Product SEO	/ 4
4 · Collection SEO	/ 3
5 · Content	/ 3
6 · Internal Linking	/ 2
7 · Visibility & Technical	/ 6

NEXT STEPS

What You Can Do Next, On Your Own

A few genuinely doable actions, regardless of where your score landed:

- Rewrite the title and meta description on your single best-selling product (Section 3).
- Add one paragraph of real introductory copy to your highest-priority collection page (Section 4).
- Connect Search Console today if you haven't, and check it once (Section 7).
- Fix the single worst broken link or navigation gap you found (Sections 2 and 7).

These are real fixes, not placeholders. What they won't do is give you a researched keyword strategy, a rebuilt site architecture, an optimized catalog, or a content system, since that's a genuinely larger project than a single checklist can responsibly cover.

When the Workbook Makes Sense

If your gaps are concentrated in Sections 1–2, your foundation likely needs real research and structural work before page-level optimization will pay off much. If they're concentrated in Sections 3–6, you now know *what* needs fixing, but doing that consistently across a full catalog, not just the handful of pages you checked here, is a different kind of project.

YOU NOW KNOW

- ✓ Where your store's SEO foundation is weak or incomplete
- ✓ Which product, collection, and technical fixes you can make immediately
- ✓ Whether your gaps are structural, content-based, or visibility-based

THE WORKBOOK BUILDS

- → Real keyword research without needing to become an SEO expert
- → A full site-architecture framework and repeatable product-page process
- → A content-cluster system and an internal linking plan
- → A technical health check and a 90-day plan tying it all together

You now know where your store's SEO foundation is weak or incomplete. The Shopify SEO Workbook walks you through actually building and improving it.

KEEP THIS HANDY

One-Page Printable Checklist

Keep this visible and re-run it as your catalog grows.

SEARCH FOUNDATION

- [ ] I know real customer search language, not guesses
- [ ] My top pages target customer language, not internal terms
- [ ] My highest-priority page matches real search intent

STORE STRUCTURE

- [ ] Navigation matches how customers think, not inventory logic
- [ ] Collections reflect real, distinct customer intent
- [ ] No near-duplicate collections competing with each other
- [ ] Every important page is actually linked from somewhere

PRODUCT SEO

- [ ] Best-sellers have unique titles and meta descriptions
- [ ] Descriptions answer real buying questions
- [ ] Images have real, descriptive alt text
- [ ] Key buying info is on the page, not hidden

COLLECTION SEO

- [ ] Top collections have real, unique intro copy
- [ ] No collections duplicating each other
- [ ] Titles and metadata are specific, not generic

CONTENT

- [ ] Content answers pre-purchase questions
- [ ] Content links back to relevant product/collection pages
- [ ] Content follows a real plan, not a scattered burst

INTERNAL LINKING

- [ ] Important pages link to each other meaningfully
- [ ] Content links use descriptive text, not "click here"

VISIBILITY & TECHNICAL

- [ ] Search Console connected and checked recently
- [ ] Key pages confirmed indexed via URL Inspection
- [ ] Free Google product listings set up (if applicable)
- [ ] Site feels fast and intentional on mobile
- [ ] No broken links found in a spot check
- [ ] Site copy clearly states what I sell, in text an AI tool or a human could read